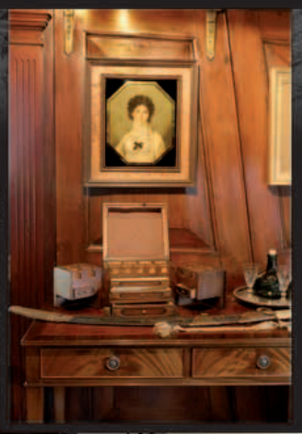
# BELOW DECKS

**AS WELL AS THREE GUN DECKS**, *Victory* had, below the waterline, the orlop deck and the hold. To keep the ship stable, the heaviest guns were toward the bottom of the ship. There were 32-pounder guns on the lower gun deck, 24-pounders on the middle gun deck, and 12-pounders on the upper gun deck. The gun decks also provided living quarters for most of the crew, in airless, damp, and overcrowded conditions. The orlop deck was safe from enemy fire, and thus the chosen site for the powder magazines and the surgeon's operating room.



**Day cabin**
The day cabin was the admiral's private study. It was here that he wrote letters and kept his most valuable personal effects.



**Great cabin**
Situated at the rear of the upper gun deck, the great cabin served as the admiral's quarters. The most comfortable part of the ship, it was divided into a day cabin, a dining cabin, and a bed space.

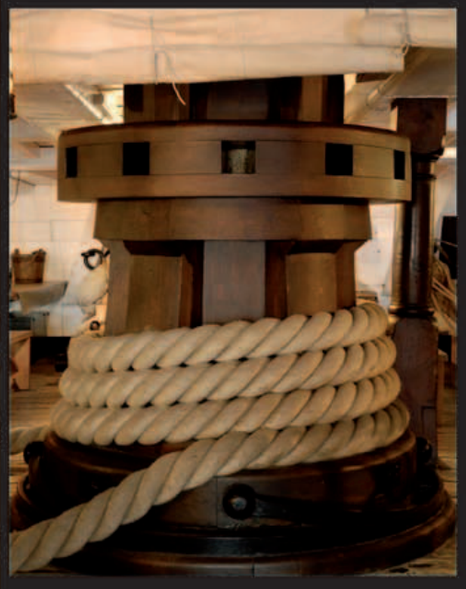


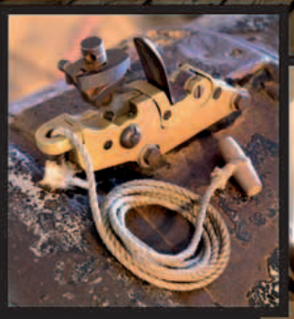
**Admiral's cot**
The admiral and other high-ranking officers slept in box-like cots that hung from the ceiling. The cot also served as a coffin in the event of the officer's death.

**Gun decks**
The *Victory* had 88 guns arranged on its three gun decks, the lowest of which contained the heaviest Blomfield 32-pounder guns. Other lighter guns (including carronades) were arranged on the poop deck and the forecastle.



**Capstan**
*Victory* had two capstans, one for raising and lowering anchors, and another for lifting stores. Over a hundred men could be needed to haul in a cable, which wrapped around a drum on the deck beneath.





**Gun lock**
*Victory*'s guns were fired with flintlock mechanisms. Pulling the lanyard (cord) made the flint spark, igniting the primer, which in turn ignited the main charge in the barrel.



**Marines' quarters**
The middle gun deck was home to *Victory*'s 146 Royal Marines, who, like the sailors who occupied the other decks, all ate and slept between the guns. They were the ships' soldiers, and were trusted to protect the ship's officers in the event of a mutiny.